

Your formal project proposal is in --> now it's time to execute. This update should reflect a shift from “planning mode” to “building mode.”

We want to see real traction: setup, early implementation, and structured goals. Even if you're off to a slower start, you need to identify blockers now --> **silence ≠ progress.**

Required Questions:

- **AI's role in software development and what you can do about it**

Watch the video in this link

here **completely:** <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dZxyeYBxPBALinks to an>



[external site.](#) . After watching the full video, describe in one paragraph what you believe is the most fundamental shift AI will cause in the software development life cycle in 2026 and explain how this shift changes the skills you must develop and the way you will approach job searching after graduation **(Every member must write their own independent paragraph and put it in the submission with their names).**

- The biggest shift in my opinion is the transition from manual implementation to autonomous. For example, engineers have been evolving, instead of developers writing code, they have AI agents that execute the tasks for them. With this in mind syntax will no longer be the main focus but developing system architecture since being just a “back-end” or “front-end developer” will probably become less relevant. -Dillon Opperman
- I think the biggest shift in AI will complicate software development immensely. The skills needed to complete jobs are not limited to the jobs content alone anymore, they require the use of AI tools to complete tasks more efficiently. With the door open and AI already building large programs from cloned windows operating systems to excel spreadsheets, development is going to change drastically and not solely rely on the programmer themselves. -Jake Beren
- To preface, I have always been incredibly skeptical when it comes to AI. To be more specific, I hate it. I think it's all a gift: It's millionaire and billionaire ‘tech bros’ trying (and most of the time, failing) to make humans obsolete, so

they don't have to pay their work force; It steals the art of proper artists and the code of open source programmers without compensation or permission to make copies via algorithms (which, in my mind, should be an egregious violation of copyright law); It's actively making people dumber as many school children use it to cheat on all their assignments as they don't think they need practice on what they were taught only to forget what they were taught and be forced to either fail the course or use AI more (and fail at life); And it's polluting the environment while being a massive energy and water sink (which, on top of raising prices on energy and water for everyone, also means the companies selling it are indirectly receiving subsidies from taxpayer money as energy and water utilities are subsidized to keep them cheap for American citizens).

With this in mind, I watched the entire video, and I am entirely unimpressed. For the first ten minutes this guy is singing the praises of all these new innovations in AI development. Innovations such as *checks notes* 'breaking bigger tasks into smaller tasks' and... 'Making the big task AI create sub AI agents for the smaller tasks' and... 'If the AI fails the task just run it again'... *This* is the bleeding edge of AI? Are you serious?

After this he talks about how if all of this work can be done by AI in a fraction of the time while 74% of the time beating human experts in the field, then why hasn't work shifted to be more AI focused? He says it's 'capability overhang.' I say it's either because the studies are rubbish or – if I'm being forced to imagine the studies are correct - a 74% success rate still means a 26% failure rate. At the rate these AIs are producing data, that 26% failure rate takes a substantial amount of time and manpower to find – as if an AI is producing this garbage data, odds are another AI won't be able to tell that it is garbage data, necessitating human oversight.

Also, most of these 'innovations' require more and more AI agents, which means more data centers, which means more pollution, more water usage, and more electricity usage. All of this means more public will to stop the production of data centers, to regulate AI in the workplace, to free up hardware for the rest of us, and to hold AI companies accountable for stealing the work of thousands of unpaid programmers and artists. Also, if this 'endless stream' of AI code output gets fed into the training data of AI, that will lead to model collapse, which will make AI less and less useful as time goes on. At what point do we ask ourselves the question "will human workers be *cheaper* than AI?"

As for what I think the shift AI will cause in the software development cycle in

2026 will be? I think AI is a bubble, like housing was in 2008 (and almost certainly currently is as well) and I think the bubble will pop in 2026, or perhaps it'll take a few more years as more millionaires and billionaires shovel money into it to keep it from popping. As for what I intend to do, I intend to learn more about how programs perform their functions so that I can optimize and design the code that AI outputs in the short term, and so I can be one of the few who can still code at a professional level when the bubble inevitably pops. -Jacob Oswald

- Writing code from scratch appears to be decreasingly popular as with AI this can be done much faster through a specific enough prompt. The biggest shift will be debugging and refining the generated code as well as understanding which models perform better at which operations. I personally don't want a job at a heavily AI company, so the slower hiring may not affect me depending on my ability to find a job that fits my preferences. -Josh Schmidt
- I think the biggest change in the software development cycle is the change from developers writing the code to, instead, developers directing AI tools to help with orchestrating/developing/fixing the whole process. This change makes me believe that I should develop some stronger skills in systems thinking, prompt design or engineering, and evaluating outputs of AI. Memorizing frameworks or understanding syntax will become something of the past, so I'm approaching job searching with demonstrating that I know how to leverage AI to increase productivity and deliver much more value. (-Kristian Neilands)
- I feel that the biggest shift AI has on software development is to emphasize more on the ability to manage these AI tools and ensure your vision with explicit context via automation.

A little analogy from my parallel processing course; a master node directs other worker nodes that listen to it in parallel processing in order to get quicker times in processing data/info/etc, and it feels very familiar to how you (the master node) would direct the AI agents (worker nodes) to process a task in quicker times. The other comparison is that those worker nodes can and will fail, so it's on the master node to monitor and reinforce them; the same can be said for us and AI agents.

What I am getting at is the biggest ability we need to work on is pointing out these agents to do their own work, but with the prospect of your own vision as guidance. It's still the human that makes the decision; its AI that carries it out. - Ben Potter

- **Proposal Feedback & Adjustments**

Have you received feedback on your proposal? Are there any changes you're making to the original plan?

- We have received feedback on our proposal, and it was mostly positive, so we're not making any major changes to the original plan.
- The one criticism we received was our logic plan which appeared unclear. We have laid out some solutions to this issue and took this criticism into account by understanding better what our stack/plan should look like more realistically.

- **Progress Since Last Update**

What specific things have you built, designed, written, tested, or setup since May 26? Be concrete.

- The github [DillonOpperman/Sift-Shift: Build Based Game / Early Development](#)
- We have downloaded GameMaker Studio to each team member's machines.
- We are all in the process of learning how Gamemaker works using their tutorial videos.
- We made a design decisions document to ensure everyone is on the same page and to ease discussion about such things.

- **Team Member Contributions (REQUIRED)**

List each member and what they've worked on in the past two weeks.

(e.g., "Kira: built login screen", "Ben: set up DB schema", "Sami: not present this cycle")

1. *Set up the GitHub repo and sent requests to collaborators. Sent BiWeekly2 doc to group. Added Readme and requirements.txt on GitHub as well as stackStructure.txt. Worked on this doc and brainstormed on the Design Decision Document with the team (Dillon).*
2. *Laid out current major issues and current solutions to these issues. Started working and contributed on the Design Decisions Document. (Ben)*
3. *Scheduled, planned, and facilitated meetings. Created Design Decisions Doc and contributed heavily. Contributed some to the BiWeekly2 document. (Jacob)*
4. *Worked on this doc and Design Decision Document. (Jake Beren)*

5. *Worked on the BiWeekly report, and helped with key decisions in the Design Decision Document. (Kristian Neilands)*

- **Any Major Issues So Far?**

Are you running into technical problems, communication gaps, or tool-related challenges?

1. The biggest issue so far has been getting on the same schedule so we can meet in person and get work started (getting correct software installed, deciding if Windows/Linux/Macs will work on this application or if we need to pivot responsibilities).
 - I. Current solution (very subject to change week-by-week):
wednesdays-thursdays around 3:00PM at Milner Library works for most of the group.
2. We are trying to consider within the group how we are going to link together everything in the stack and how to use GameMaker (how to connect GameMaker Studio to Java, Java to Github)
 - I. Current solution: Tutorials provided by GameMaker and youtube tutorials we found
3. Lastly, we're still in the process of finalizing our concept of the game as well (what is the core gameplay loop? What can and cannot the player do?)
 - I. Current solution: Documentation that lays out what we want to implement in the project; considerations from each team member will factor in for each design choice we make.

- **Next Milestone or Deliverable**

What does your team plan to complete before the next update (June 23)? Be specific — no vague goals.

1. **Have everything installed on each group member's computer (and working). Each group member should be able to push changes onto GitHub and know how to install new merges, commits, ect.**
 2. **Have roles defined/responsibilities (programmer, system administrator, etc.)**
 3. **Add more if possible**
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☒ Submission Notes:

- Submit **one update per team**
 - All team members must be accounted for
 - Be honest. We're here to help if you're stuck — but only if we know.
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 Sample Response Template:

1. Proposal Feedback & Adjustments:

Our proposal was approved, but Prof. Rashid suggested we reduce scope by cutting two optional features. We're focusing on the MVP only for now.

2. Progress Since Last Update:

- Set up React dev environment
- Built login and registration UI (frontend only)
- Started designing database schema in Lucidchart
- Created Slack reminders to meet twice a week

3. Team Member Contributions:

- Asha: designed UI mockups and login form
- Leo: set up Express backend skeleton
- May: managing team schedule and writing frontend unit tests
- Zane: writing backend DB schema and seed data
- Priya: no updates (family emergency — notified group)

4. Issues So Far:

Deciding how to do auth (JWT vs Firebase). Also lost some time syncing everyone's dev environments.

5. Next Milestone:

Have user registration working end-to-end with database storage and error handling by June 23.